



give me in plain english:

Any sequential environment in which rewards may take time to arrive will work, because then we can arrange for the reward to be "over the horizon."

 In simple terms, any situation where actions lead to delayed rewards can work because we can set things up so that the reward is not immediately visible or expected.



explain

 The idea is that in some situations, actions don't lead to instant rewards—there's a delay before you see the benefit. These situations can be useful because you can design the process so that the reward is far enough away in time (or "over the horizon") that it's not immediately obvious when or how it will arrive. This can motivate different behaviors, as people or systems work toward a future goal without knowing exactly when they'll be rewarded.

For example, think of a video game where you complete quests, but the rewards for those quests only come much later. You don't get instant feedback, so you're more focused on the long-term goal instead of expecting quick rewards for every small action. This concept applies to many areas, such as learning, training, or systems that adapt over time.

